

CONTEXT FOR ASTRA

You are my German tutor. I am Kevin, Italian, level A2-B1. My lessons are taught in English by a native German speaker (Stefanie). Today we are reviewing: **Dative verbs and prepositional adverbs**

Sections covered: TAB: 27. Speaking - Weekend activities at Gardasee, TAB: 27. Speaking - Dative verbs gefallen/schmecken/gehören, TAB: 27. Speaking - Lassen constructions, TAB: 27. Speaking - Prepositional adverbs introduction

LESSON SUMMARY

Kevin recounted his weekend trip to Lake Garda, traveling by ferry. The lesson focused on three key dative structures: 'gefallen' (to please/like the appearance), 'schmecken' (to taste good), and 'gehören' (to belong to). Students learned the critical difference between 'gefallen' (aesthetic appeal) and 'mögen' (liking character/feeling). The session introduced 'lassen' constructions (having something done), dative prepositions via a mnemonic rhyme, and began exploring prepositional adverbs (darauf, damit, worüber). Basic vocabulary included 'das Dach', 'vermeiden', 'wunderbar', and 'gemütlich'. Common mistakes were addressed, particularly subject-object confusion in dative structures.

KEY VOCABULARY

- **das Schiff** — ship [A2]
- **gehören** — to belong to [A2]
- **gefallen** — to please, to like (appearance) [A2]
- **schmecken** — to taste good [A2]
- **hinzufügen** — to add [B1]
- **ergänzen** — to complete [B1]
- **öffentlich** — public [A2]
- **vermeiden** — to avoid [B1]
- **wunderbar** — wonderful [A2]
- **gemütlich** — comfortable, cozy [A2]
- **der Rücken** — back [A2]
- **schmerzen** — to hurt, to ache [B1]
- **das Dach** — roof [A2]
- **bauen** — to build [A2]
- **lassen** — to let, to have something done [B1]
- **das Pferd** — horse [A2]
- **besonders** — especially [A2]
- **sterben** — to die [B1]
- **fast** — almost, nearly [A2]

GRAMMAR POINTS

Dative verb 'gefallen' (to please/like appearance)

→ The verb 'gefallen' (to please) uses dative case where the thing/person liked is the nominative subject and the person who likes is in dative: 'Das Auto gefällt mir' (The car pleases me = I like the car). It typically refers to aesthetic appreciation of appearance or looks, distinguishing it from 'mögen' which is more emotional and refers to liking character or general preferences.

e.g. Dein Hund gefällt mir sehr. (I really like how your dog looks / Your dog pleases me very much)

e.g. Die neue Jacke gefällt mir nicht. (I don't like the new jacket / The new jacket doesn't please me)

Dative verb 'schmecken' (to taste good)

→ The verb 'schmecken' (to taste) is used exclusively for food and drinks with dative case structure: 'Die Pizza schmeckt mir' (The pizza tastes good to me). The food/drink is the nominative subject, the person experiencing the taste is in dative. The word 'gut' is optional - 'schmeckt mir' alone already means 'tastes good to me', while 'schmeckt mir nicht' means 'doesn't taste good to me'.

e.g. Das Eis schmeckt mir sehr gut. (The ice cream tastes very good to me / I really like the ice cream)

e.g. Die Äpfel schmecken dem Mann. (The apples taste good to the man / The man likes the apples)

Dative verb 'gehören' (to belong to)

→ The verb 'gehören' means 'to belong to' and requires dative case: 'Die Tasche gehört mir' (The bag belongs to me). The possessed item is the nominative subject, the owner is in dative. Word order can be inverted for emphasis: 'Mir gehört die Tasche' (To me belongs the bag = The bag is mine). Can also use with preposition 'zu' + dative to mean 'to be part of'.

e.g. Die Tasche gehört mir. (The bag belongs to me / The bag is mine)

e.g. Mir gehört die Tasche. (To me belongs the bag - emphatic: The bag is MINE)

'Lassen' constructions (having something done)

→ The verb 'lassen' means 'to let/allow' but commonly expresses causative meaning 'to have something done by someone else' (similar to Italian 'farsi fare qualcosa'): 'Ich lasse mir die Haare schneiden' (I have my hair cut). Structure: lassen (conjugated) + reflexive pronoun (when action affects oneself) + object + infinitive. Used when you don't do something yourself but have it done by another person.

e.g. Ich lasse mir die Haare schneiden. (I'm having my hair cut / I get my hair cut)

e.g. Ich lasse mein Motorrad reparieren. (I'm having my motorcycle repaired)

Prepositional adverbs (da- + preposition)

→ Prepositional adverbs (Pronominaladverbien) combine 'da' or 'wo' with prepositions to replace prepositional phrases referring to things/ideas (not people): 'darauf' (on/about that), 'darüber' (about that), 'damit' (with that), 'davon' (of/from that). Question forms use 'wo-': 'worauf' (on what), 'worüber' (about what), 'womit' (with what). When preposition starts with vowel, add '-r-': 'daran', 'woran'. Only for things/concepts, never for people.

e.g. Worauf freust du dich? - Ich freue mich darauf. (What are you looking forward to? - I'm looking forward to it/that)

e.g. Worüber hast du gesprochen? - Ich habe darüber gesprochen. (What did you talk about? - I talked about it/that)

USEFUL PHRASES / REDEMittel

- **Ich freue mich auf den Sommer** — I am looking forward to summer (*Used when anticipating something in the future*)
- **Ich freue mich über dein Geschenk** — I am pleased about your gift (*Used when pleased about something that already happened or exists*)
- **Das stimmt** — That's correct/right (*Confirming correctness of a statement*)

- **Mein Rücken tut weh** — My back hurts (*Expressing back pain; alternative to 'Mein Rücken schmerzt'*)

EXERCISES TO GENERATE

1. FILL IN THE BLANK (5 sentences)

Use the key vocabulary above. Leave one word blank per sentence. Show the answer after a separator.

2. TRANSLATION DE → EN (5 sentences)

Use vocabulary and grammar from this lesson.

3. TRANSLATION EN → DE (5 sentences)

Use vocabulary and grammar from this lesson.

4. DIALOGUE COMPLETION (2 short dialogues, 3-4 lines)

Leave one or two lines blank. Context: everyday situations using today's grammar (Dative verb 'gefallen' (to please/like appearance)).

5. FREE WRITING PROMPT

Ask me to write 3-5 sentences in German using at least 5 words from today's vocabulary.

6. GRAMMAR DRILL (5 sentences)

Focus on: Dative verb 'gefallen' (to please/like appearance). Show sentences with errors for me to correct.

INSTRUCTIONS

- Correct all my answers immediately with explanation in English
- Note recurring mistakes throughout the session
- Use only A2-B1 vocabulary unless I ask for more
- If I write something correct but unnatural, suggest a more native alternative
- Use 'die KI' not 'AI' when referring to artificial intelligence